

## Stony Justice

A MAN carrying **bales** of cotton cloth stopped to rest beneath a tree. Next to the tree was a large stone **statue** of the Buddha. The man was so tired that he **fell asleep** in the shelter of the **pedestal**. When he awoke he found that his bales of cloth had **vanished**. He immediately reported the matter to the police.



The judge said that as there were no witnesses to the crime, the Buddha must have stolen the goods.

“The Buddha is **supposed** to **look after** the welfare of the people, but he has failed to perform his **holy** duty. Arrest him.”

The police arrested the stone Buddha and carried it to court. A crowd of people followed. There was laughter and much joking **at the judge’s expense**.

When the judge appeared, he was very angry.

“How dare you people appear before the court laughing and joking? You have insulted the court, therefore I have to arrest and fine you.”

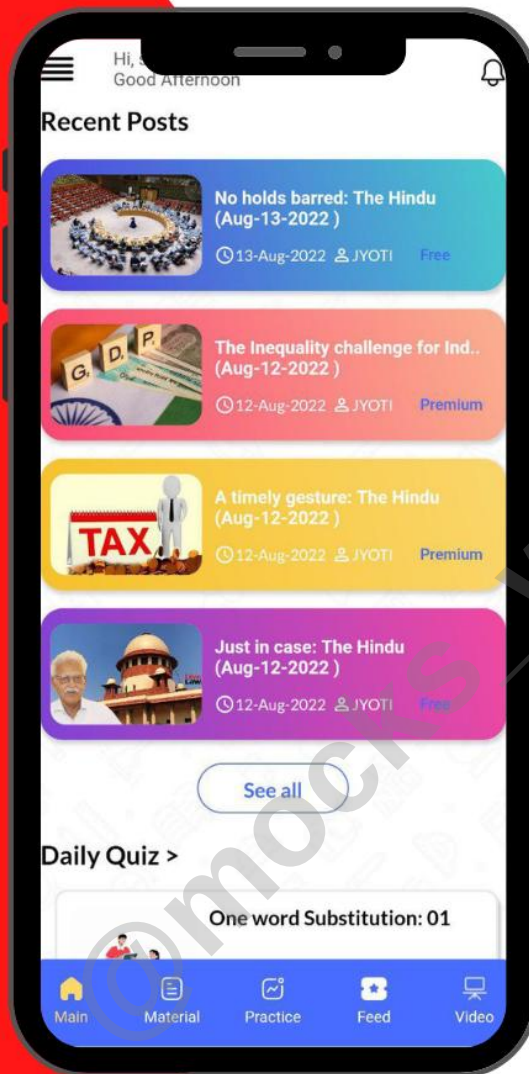
The people fell silent and began to look afraid.

“I will **defer** the arrest,” continued the judge, “if each one of you brings a bale of cotton cloth to the court by tomorrow. Anyone who fails will be arrested.”

The merchant immediately **recognized** one of the bales as his own and the thief was discovered. The judge arrested him. The stone Buddha who had **escaped imprisonment** was returned to his **pedestal**. People could have **sworn** that his smile was wider.

### Vocabulary

1. **Stony** (adjective) – not having or showing feeling or sympathy. बेदर्द
2. **Bale** (noun) – bundle, pack, parcel, load, bundle-pack गड्ढर
3. **Statue** (noun) – sculpture, figure, effigy, idol, monument मूर्ति
4. **Fall asleep** (phrase) – doze off, drift off, nod off, drop off, go to sleep नींद आना
5. **Pedestal** (adjective) – base-like, plinth-side, base-mounted, foot-level, stand-side चबूतरे-का
6. **Vanish** (verb) – disappear, evaporate, melt away, fade, go missing गायब होना
7. (be) **Supposed** (to) (adjective) – expected, meant, intended, required, obliged अपेक्षित
8. **Look after** (phrasal verb) – take care of, tend, watch over, protect, safeguard देखभाल करना
9. **Holy** (adjective) – sacred, divine, sanctified, saintly, pious पवित्र
10. **At someone's expense** (phrase) – at the cost of, to the detriment of, by ridiculing, making fun of, at one's disadvantage का मज़ाक उड़ाकर
11. **Defer** (verb) – postpone, delay, put off, adjourn, hold over टालना
12. **Recognise** (verb) – identify, spot, discern, make out, acknowledge पहचानना
13. **Escape** (verb) – get away, flee, elude, evade, slip away बच निकलना
14. **Imprisonment** (noun) – incarceration, confinement, detention, custody, jail कारावास
15. **Pedestal** (noun) – base, plinth, stand, socle, dais चबूतरा
16. **Swear** (verb) – vow, take an oath, affirm, aver, pledge कसम खाना



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